PEW RESEARCH CENTER
July 19-22, 2012 OMNIBUS
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,001

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE;] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
July 19-22, 2012	39	29	16	16	*
July 12-15, 2012	32	33	18	17	1
July 5-8, 2012	34	28	18	19	1
June 28-July 1, 2012	38	28	15	18	1
June 21-24, 2012	33	32	17	17	*
June 14-17, 2012	39	28	15	17	*
June 7-10, 2012	35	32	15	18	*
May 31-June 3, 2012	37	34	13	14	1
May 24-27, 2012	33	31	19	16	1
May 17-20, 2012	35	30	16	19	*
May 10-13, 2012	40	26	16	17	*
May 3-6, 2012	38	29	13	20	*
April 26-29, 2012	34	32	17	16	1
April 19-22, 2012	35	35	13	14	2
April 12-15, 2012	39	28	16	17	1
April 5-8, 2012	37	31	16	16	1
March 29-April 1, 2012	34	33	15	18	1
March 22-25, 2012	36	29	16	18	1
March 15-18, 2012	40	35	11	14	1
March 8-11, 2012	37	32	14	17	*
March 1-4, 2012	41	27	15	17	1
February 23-26, 2012	37	33	14	15	1
February 16-20, 2012	33	32	16	17	1
February 9-12, 2012	42	30	14	13	1
February 2-5, 2012	38	32	16	13	1
January 26-29, 2012	35	31	16	19	*
January 19-22, 2012	35	30	16	19	1
January 12-15, 2012	33	32	14	20	1
January 5-8, 2012	39	31	15	15	*
December 15-18, 2011	36	32	14	16	1
December 8-11, 2011	41	29	13	16	1
December 1-4, 2011	40	33	13	13	1
November 17-20, 2011	35	33	16	15	1
November 10-13, 2011	39	31	15	14	*
November 3-6, 2011	37	31	15	17	1
October 27-30, 2011	38	33	14	15	1
October 20-23, 2011	38	32	14	16	1
October 13-16, 2011	39	32	14	14	*
October 6-9, 2011	43	28	14	14	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	46	26	14	14	*
September 22-25, 2011	44	33	11	11	*
September 8-11, 2011	40	30	15	14	1
September 1-4, 2011	44	30	11	15	*
August 25-28, 2011	44	28	14	13	1
August 18-21, 2011	44	29	12	14	1
August 4-7, 2011	46	30	11	13	1
July 28-31, 2011	43	30	13	13	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July 21-24, 2011	41	32	13	13	1
July 14-17, 2011	41	30	14	14	1
July 7-10, 2011	36	30	15	18	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	38	32	13	16	1
June 23-26, 2011	37	29	15	19	*
June 16-19, 2011	39	33	14	13	*
June 9-12, 2011	39	30	15	16	1
June 2-5, 2011	35	34	17	14	*
May 19-22, 2011	33	34	17	16	*
May 12-15, 2011	32	32	17	18	2
May 5-8, 2011	40	35	15	9	1
April 21-25, 2011	41	33	12	14	*
April 14-17, 2011	44	30	14	12	1
April 7-10, 2011	46	30	14	10	*
March 31-April 3, 2011	42	31	16	11	0
March 24-27, 2011	36	32	17	15	*
March 17-20, 2011	38	32	17	13	*
March 10-13, 2011	40	30	16	13	*
March 3-6, 2011	37	31	17	13	1
February 24-27, 2011	49	29	11	10	*
February 17-20, 2011	35	33	14	17	*
February 10-13, 2011	36	34	13	16	*
February 3-6, 2011	35	37	14	14	*
January 20-23, 2011	37	33	14	15	1
January 13-16, 2011	37	29	15	18	1
January 6-9, 2011	39	37	11	12	1

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Economy-Trends.pdf

b. Political violence in Syria					
July 19-22, 2012	17	24	23	36	1
June 28-July 1, 2012	13	19	26	42	*
June 14-17, 2012	15	24	21	40	1
May 31-June 3, 2012	12	25	25	37	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
April 12-15, 2012: *International efforts to stop political violence in Syria*	14	23	25	37	1
April 5-8, 2012	15	21	27	37	1
March 15-28, 2012: *Political violence in Syria*	16	26	27	30	1
March 8-11, 2012	17	23	23	37	1
February 23-26, 2012	18	24	21	35	1
February 9-12, 2012	17	23	23	36	*
January 12-15, 2012	12	17	26	45	1
August 4-7, 2011: *Political violence following uprisings in Syria*	10	19	26	44	1
May 5-8, 2011	14	27	30	28	1
June 2-5, 2011: *Anti-government protests and violence in some Middle Eastern countries*	18	25	25	32	*
April 28-May 1, 2011	18	29	25	27	1
February 3-6, 2011: *Anti-government protests in Egypt and other Middle Eastern countries*	32	35	16	18	*
January 27-30, 2011	17	26	21	35	*
c. News about candidates for the 2012 presidential election					
July 19-22, 2012	35	22	17	25	1
July 12-15, 2012	33	24	20	23	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July 5-8, 2012	29	26	20	25	*
June 28-July 1, 2012	32	24	19	25	*
June 21-24, 2012	27	30	17	25	1
June 14-17, 2012	31	30	15	24	*
June 7-10, 2012	30	29	16	25	1
May 31-June 3, 2012	29	28	19	23	1
May 24-27, 2012	32	28	16	24	1
May 17-20, 2012	31	26	19	23	*
May 10-13, 2012	34	23	18	24	*
May 3-6, 2012	29	27	19	24	*
April 26-29, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
April 19-22, 2012	29	29	20	20	1
April 12-15, 2012	32	28	16	23	1
April 5-8, 2012	31	27	18	23	*
March 29-April 1, 2012	23	29	21	27	*
March 22-25, 2012	28	28	18	25	1
March 15-18, 2012	28	31	17	24	*
March 8-11, 2012	28	27	21	23	*
March 1-4, 2012	31	24	20	24	1
February 23-26, 2012	28	29	18	24	1
February 16-20, 2012	25	29	19	25	2
February 9-12, 2012	35	25	18	20	1
February 2-5, 2012	30	27	20	21	1
January 26-29, 2012	28	30	21	21	1
January 19-22, 2012	28	30	17	24	*
January 12-15, 2012	29	29	18	23	1
January 5-8, 2012	29	30	16	25	*
December 15-18, 2011	26	24	20	29	1
December 8-11, 2011	27	27	18	28	*
December 1-4, 2011	25	28	20	26	1
November 17-20, 2011	24	31	21	23	1
November 3-6, 2011	22	31	20	26	1
October 27-30, 2011	21	26	21	30	1
October 20-23, 2011	21	28	22	28	1
October 13-16, 2011	26	29	22	23	1
October 6-9, 2011	25	25	23	27	1
September 29-October 2, 2011	27	26	21	25	*
September 22-25, 2011	25	26	23	25	1
September 15-18, 2011	24	28	21	27	1
September 8-11, 2011	22	26	21	31	*
September 1-4, 2011	22	23	22	32	1
August 25-28, 2011	22	22	22	33	1
August 18-21, 2011	27	26	19	28	1
August 11-14, 2011	19	24	20	36	1
August 4-7, 2011	18	21	22	37	1
July 28-31, 2011	17	27	21	35	1
July 21-24, 2011	17	22	28	32	*
July 14-17, 2011	18	26	27	28	1
July 7-10, 2011	16	23	27	33	1
June 30-July 3, 2011	21	28	24	25	2
June 23-26, 2011	19	26	24	31	*
June 16-19, 2011	23	29	23	25	*
June 9-12, 2011	18	30	22	30	1
June 2-5, 2011	21	31	22	26	*
May 26-29, 2011	20	27	24	28	*
May 19-22, 2011	15	27	24	32	1
May 12-15, 2011	15	22	26	35	1
May 5-8, 2011	16	24	27	32	1
April 21-25, 2011	18	26	23	32	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
April 14-17, 2011	20	23	29	27	1
March 24-27, 2011	13	19	26	41	1
March 10-13, 2011	15	21	26	38	0
February 10-13, 2011	16	19	24	40	*
February 3-6, 2011	15	20	23	42	*

SEE TRENDS FOR PREVIOUS YEARS: http://www.people-press.org/files/2011/11/NII-Election-Trends.pdf

d. The debate in Washington over automatic spending cuts and tax increases that will take effect in January unless Congress acts					
July 19-22, 2012	23	21	22	33	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
February 16-20, 2012: *Congress passing a bill to extend payroll tax cuts and unemployment benefits*[1]	24	27	21	27	1
August 4-7, 2011: *Congress and the president agreeing to cut federal spending and raise the debt limit*	46	25	13	14	1
December 16-19, 2010[2]: *The extension of tax cuts and unemployment benefits approved by Congress and signed by President Obama*	37	27	15	19	1
December 9-12, 2010: *The agreement reached between Barack Obama and Congressional Republicans to extend tax cuts and unemployment benefits*	37	29	15	17	1
December 2-5, 2010: *The debate in Washington over the federal income tax cuts passed when George W. Bush was president*	39	26	17	17	1
September 16-19, 2010: *The debate in Washington over competing Democratic and Republican tax plans*	21	24	21	34	*
September 9-12, 2010	16	19	22	42	1
May 8-11, 2009: *The debate in Washington over the federal budget*	22	28	19	31	*
March 27-30, 2009: *Debate over Barack Obama's budget proposal*	28	34	18	19	1
February 27-March 2, 2009: *Barack Obama's budget proposal for next year that raises taxes on wealthy Americans and increases spending on health care, education and other programs*	47	34	9	10	*
May, 2003: *George W. Bush's tax cut and economic stimulus plan*	25	36	22	15	2
February, 2003	26	33	23	16	2
January, 2003	28	34	21	15	2
February, 2002: *Debate in Congress over G.W. Bush's budget and tax cut plan*	17	31	28	23	1
April, 2001	24	38	20	18	*
February, 2001: *G.W. Bush's tax cut plan*	31	35	19	14	1
September, 1999: *The debate in Washington over how much to cut taxes*	18	30	28	23	1

[1] The wording of item PEW.1d was changed after the first night of interviewing (February 16, 2012) to reflect Congress passing this legislation. On February 16, 2012, the item wording was "Negotiations in Congress to extend payroll tax cuts and unemployment benefits."

[2] The wording of item PEW.1c was changed after the first night of interviewing (December 16, 2010), to reflect Congress passing and Obama signing this legislation. On December 16, 2010 the item read "The debate in Washington over extending tax cuts and unemployment benefits."

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
July, 1999	14	34	21	31	*
June, 1997: *Competing proposals on ways to cut taxes as part of the recent bipartisan budget agreement*	11	27	28	33	1
September, 1992 *(RVs)*: *George Bush's plan to improve the economy by cutting government spending and cutting taxes*	28	44	18	9	1
e. Drought conditions across much of the country and its impact on farms and crops					
July 19-22, 2012	28	30	19	22	1
August, 1988: *The drought and its effects on American farmers (RVs)*	49	39	10	2	0
f. The shooting at a movie theater near Denver, Colorado					
July 20-22, 2012[3]	48	25	15	11	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
April 5-8, 2012: *A shooting at a small college in Oakland, California, that killed seven people*	21	28	25	25	2
March 1-4, 2012: *A deadly school shooting near Cleveland*	26	31	22	19	1
December 8-11, 2011: *Deadly shootings at Virginia Tech University*	20	27	29	24	1
August 7-10, 2011: *A shooting at a fitness club in Pennsylvania*	13	28	25	34	1
June 12-15, 2009: *A deadly shooting at the Holocaust Memorial Museum in Washington, D.C.*	26	34	17	23	*
January 13-16, 2011: *News about a Congresswoman and others shot in Tucson, Arizona*	49	28	12	11	1
April 3-6, 2009: *A shooter killing several people at an immigration services center in Binghamton, New York*	26	32	19	23	*
March 13-16, 2009: *A shooting spree in Alabama that resulted in the death of 11 people*	18	33	24	25	*
February 15-18, 2008: *The shootings at Northern Illinois University that resulted in the death of 7 people*	26	40	19	15	0
February 8-11, 2008: *A shooting at a city council meeting in Missouri where six people were killed*	13	28	25	33	1
December 14-17, 2007: *Shootings at two religious centers in Colorado*	17	31	24	27	1
December 7-10, 2007: *A shooting at a shopping mall in Omaha, Nebraska where eight people were killed*	30	36	18	15	1
October 12-15, 2007: *The shooting at a high school in Cleveland, Ohio*	22	32	25	20	1
April 20-23, 2007: *The shootings at Virginia Tech University that resulted in the death of 33 people*	45	37	13	5	*
October, 2006: *Recent shootings at schools in Pennsylvania and other states*	46	33	12	8	1

[3] Item was asked from July 20-22, 2012 only. N=780.

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
March, 2000: *The shooting of a 6-year-old girl at a Michigan school*	40	38	15	7	*
September, 1999: *The shootings in a Jewish community center in Los Angeles*	29	34	22	14	1
Late April, 1999: *The shooting of students and teachers by two students at a Colorado high school*	68	24	6	2	*
June, 1998: *The shooting at a high school in Springfield, Oregon*	46	36	14	4	*
March, 1998: *The shooting at a middle school in Jonesboro, Arkansas*	49	33	12	5	1

NO QUESTION PEW.2

ASK ALL:
Thinking about the presidential candidates…
PEW.3 Do you feel you need to learn more about **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]** to form a clear impression of him, or do you already know pretty much what you need to know?

	Need to learn more	Already know enough	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. Barack Obama July 19-22, 2012	12	86	2
b. Mitt Romney July 19-22, 2012	30	66	4

ASK ALL:
PEW.4 When it comes to Mitt Romney, would you like to hear more about **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**, or not?

	Yes, want to hear more	No, do not	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a. His record as governor of Massachusetts July 19-22, 2012	41	59	*
b. His record as CEO of the Bain Capital investment firm July 19-22, 2012	33	66	1
c. His religious beliefs July 19-22, 2012	18	81	1
d. His family and upbringing July 19-22, 2012	20	79	1
e. His wealth July 19-22, 2012	19	80	1
f. His federal income tax returns July 19-22, 2012	36	63	1

ASK ALL:

PEW.5 As I name some news organizations, please rate how much you think you can BELIEVE each that I name on a scale of 4 to 1. On this four point scale, "4" means you can believe all or most of what the news organization says, and "1" means you believe almost nothing of what they say. First, how would you rate the believability of **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]** on this scale of 4 to 1? How about [**NEXT ITEM**]? **[IF NECESSARY:** How would you rate the believability of **[NEXT ITEM]** on this scale of 4 to 1 where "4" means you can believe all or most of what the news organization says, and "1" means you believe almost nothing of what they say?**] [INTERVIEWERS: PROBE TO DISTINGUISH BETWEEN "NEVER HEARD OF" AND "CAN'T RATE"]**

		Believe 4	3	2	Cannot Believe 1	(VOL.) Never Heard of	(VOL.) Can't Rate
a.	USA Today						
	July 19-22, 2012	12	28	27	16	2	15
	July 8-11, 2010[4]	13	30	22	12	1	22
	Late May, 2008	13	35	26	8	2	16
	June, 2006	15	30	25	10	2	18
	May, 2004	15	32	22	8	2	21
	May, 2002	15	36	19	6	1	23
	May, 2000	17	31	20	7	2	23
	May, 1998	18	35	21	5	2	19
	April, 1996	20	34	20	9	3	14
	February, 1993	20	36	21	7	1	15
	August, 1989	21	32	18	5	6	18
	June, 1985	13	26	13	2	4	42
b.	The Wall Street Journal						
	July 19-22, 2012	17	30	19	15	1	18
	July 8-11, 2010	18	27	17	11	*	27
	Late May, 2008	20	34	17	8	2	19
	June, 2006	19	29	17	8	3	24
	May, 2004	18	31	17	8	1	25
	May, 2002	22	29	11	4	1	33
	May, 2000	27	24	9	6	4	30
	May, 1998	30	30	9	4	2	25
	April, 1996	28	29	13	7	3	20
	February, 1993	30	32	14	6	2	16
	August, 1989	30	26	9	3	6	26
	June, 1985	25	23	6	2	1	43
c.	The New York Times						
	July 19-22, 2012	14	26	24	17	*	19
	July 8-11, 2010	15	28	15	15	1	26
	Late May, 2008	14	32	19	14	2	19
	June, 2006	15	26	19	14	2	24
	May, 2004	16	31	18	10	2	23
d.	The daily newspaper you are most familiar with						
	July 19-22, 2012	18	34	27	13	*	8
	July 8-11, 2010	19	35	25	12	0	9
	Late May, 2008	21	39	23	8	1	8
	June, 2006	18	37	26	12	1	6
	May, 2004	17	33	30	12	*	8
	May, 2002	20	39	25	9	0	7
	May, 2000	23	38	24	8	*	7
	May, 1998	27	36	24	7	*	6
	April, 1996	24	37	26	8	*	5

[4] In 2010 and earlier, question introduction referred to "organizations," not "news organizations."

PEW.5 CONTINUED...

		Believe 4	3	2	Cannot Believe 1	(VOL.) Never Heard of	(VOL.) Can't Rate
	February, 1993	22	41	25	8	*	4
	August, 1989	26	41	24	7	*	2
	June, 1985	28	52	13	2	*	5
e.	CNN						
	July 19-22, 2012	24	31	23	17	*	6
	July 8-11, 2010	26	32	20	12	1	9
	Late May, 2008	28	36	18	9	1	8
	June, 2006	25	35	20	10	1	9
	May, 2004	29	36	17	8	1	9
	May, 2002	32	34	15	6	1	12
	May, 2000	33	32	14	5	1	15
	May, 1998	37	35	11	4	1	12
	April, 1996	34	37	14	4	1	10
	February, 1993	41	35	10	4	2	8
	August, 1989	33	31	11	2	8	16
	June, 1985	20	24	7	1	10	38
f.	The Fox News CABLE Channel						
	July 19-22, 2012	20	24	23	24	*	8
	July 8-11, 2010	25	26	20	20	*	8
	Late May, 2008	21	32	21	15	2	9
	June, 2006	22	29	21	15	1	12
	May, 2004	21	33	23	9	1	13
	May, 2002	19	34	20	6	2	19
	May, 2000	19	28	19	9	3	22
g.	MSNBC						
	July 19-22, 2012	17	28	24	21	1	9
	July 8-11, 2010	19	32	18	16	3	12
	Late May, 2008	21	34	22	10	2	11
	June, 2006	17	34	24	8	2	15
	May, 2004	18	36	22	8	2	14
	May, 2002	21	34	17	5	4	19
	May, 2000	19	29	15	6	8	23
h.	ABC News						
	July 19-22, 2012	21	35	25	13	*	7
	July 8-11, 2010	19	39	21	12	1	8
	Late May, 2008	22	37	25	9	1	6
	June, 2006	20	39	23	10	*	8
	May, 2004	22	36	24	9	*	9
	May, 2002	22	43	19	6	*	10
	May, 2000	26	36	20	6	*	12
	May, 1998	28	43	18	4	*	7
	April, 1996	30	44	17	5	*	4
	February, 1993	34	42	17	4	*	3
	August, 1989	30	46	14	3	1	7
	June, 1985	32	51	11	1	*	5
i.	CBS News						
	July 19-22, 2012	19	35	28	12	*	6
	July 8-11, 2010	19	36	21	13	1	11
	Late May, 2008	20	36	26	10	1	7
	June, 2006	20	34	27	10	1	8
	May, 2004	22	35	24	9	1	9
	May, 2002	23	41	19	6	*	11

PEW.5 CONTINUED…

		Believe 4	3	2	Cannot Believe 1	(VOL.) Never Heard of	(VOL.) Can't Rate
	May, 2000	26	37	20	7	*	10
	May, 1998	26	43	21	4	*	6
	April, 1996	30	42	17	6	*	5
	February, 1993	31	44	16	5	*	4
	August, 1989	29	45	16	4	1	5
	June, 1985	33	51	11	1	*	4
j.	NBC News						
	July 19-22, 2012	19	33	26	15	*	5
	July 8-11, 2010	18	40	22	13	*	7
	Late May, 2008	23	40	21	11	*	5
	June, 2006	21	39	24	8	*	8
	May, 2004	22	39	24	9	*	6
	May, 2002	23	43	19	6	*	9
	May, 2000	26	37	21	7	*	9
	May, 1998	28	42	20	4	*	6
	April, 1996	28	46	18	5	*	3
	February, 1993	31	42	18	6	*	3
	August, 1989	32	47	14	2	*	5
	June, 1985	31	51	12	1	*	5
k.	Your local TV news						
	July 19-22, 2012	27	35	24	9	*	5
	July 8-11, 2010	27	38	21	7	0	7
	Late May, 2008	27	40	21	8	*	4
	June, 2006	22	38	25	10	*	5
	May, 2004	23	36	27	9	*	5
	May, 2002	26	39	22	7	*	6
	May, 2000	30	39	19	6	*	6
	May, 1998	32	38	19	6	*	4
	June, 1985	34	47	13	1	*	5
l.	60 Minutes						
	July 19-22, 2012	27	32	21	11	1	9
	July 8-11, 2010	28	29	19	9	1	14
	Late May, 2008	27	36	21	7	1	8
	June, 2006	24	34	22	9	1	10
	May, 2004	29	33	19	9	*	10
	May, 2002	30	39	15	5	*	11
	May, 2000	31	37	17	7	*	8
	May, 1998	32	37	20	4	*	7
m.	NPR, National Public Radio						
	July 19-22, 2012	19	22	19	19	5	16
	July 8-11, 2010	20	23	18	11	7	21
	Late May, 2008[5]	19	23	18	10	12	18
	June, 2006	17	27	20	12	4	20
	May, 2004	17	25	22	12	3	21
	May, 2002	16	28	20	7	6	23
	May, 2000	16	21	18	8	13	24
	May, 1998	13	34	17	7	7	22

[5] In 2008 and earlier, item was "National Public Radio."